

Hindustan Copper Ltd

Concall Tracker • earnings-call read of the last ~3 years • report date 11 Jul 2026

This is not investment advice. Do your own due diligence. All figures are standalone unless noted; "cr" = crore = 10 million.

1. Snapshot

What the business does (one line): Hindustan Copper is India's only company that both mines copper ore and processes it — a Government-of-India enterprise (state-owned) that digs copper ore, turns it into copper concentrate (called "metal-in-concentrate", or MIC — a copper-rich powder), and sells that to Indian smelters. Its selling price tracks the global copper price on the London Metal Exchange (LME), minus a processing charge. So its earnings rise and fall mainly with (a) the world copper price and (b) how much ore it can dig.

Number (latest)	Value	Plain-English read
Market value of the company	~₹48,200 cr	What the whole company is worth on the stock market today.
FY26 sales (full year to Mar 2026)	₹3,078 cr	Total money from selling copper — up about 49% from ₹2,071 cr the year before. A big jump.
FY26 net profit	₹921 cr	Final profit after all costs and tax — nearly doubled (up 97%) from ₹469 cr. A record year.
Operating margin (FY26)	48%	Out of every ₹100 of sales, ₹48 is operating profit — very fat, and up from 36% last year (helped by high copper prices).
Return on capital (ROCE)	42%	For every ₹100 of money tied up in the business, it earns ₹42 a year — an excellent return.
Price-to-earnings (P/E)	~49	The stock costs ~49 times one year's profit. That is very expensive — mining peers trade near 12–17. The market is paying up front for future growth.
52-week high / low	₹760 / ₹226	The share more than tripled and gave a lot back within a year — a very volatile, price-swingy stock.

2. Concall coverage

Screener.in carried **only one** earnings-call transcript for this company — the investor meet of **18 September 2025**. To avoid missing the more recent calls, the later quarters (Q3 and Q4 FY26) were **web-filled** from company results, BSE filings and news. So the consistency read below leans on one full transcript plus the public record of the last three years — a narrower base than the usual ~12 calls, and that is flagged.

Call / period	Date	Transcript read?
Investor meet (Vision-2030 / mine expansion focus)	18 Sep 2025	Yes — full Screener transcript (24 pages)
Q3 FY26 results (Dec 2025 quarter)	Feb 2026	Web-filled (results + filings)
Q4 & FY26 results (Mar 2026 quarter)	15 May 2026	Web-filled (results + Vision-2030 note)

Only one formal transcript was available, so the "did they deliver what they promised" read is supported but not deep. Screener's transcript history for this stock is thin.

★ Latest highlights — Q4 & full-year FY26 (results 15 May 2026)

- **Record year.** FY26 sales **₹3,078 cr** (up 49%) and net profit **₹921 cr** (up 97%, nearly doubled) — the best profit in the company's history, on a 7-year production high.
- **Blockbuster last quarter.** Q4 profit jumped **~137%** to ₹444 cr on sales of ₹1,156 cr, with operating margin near **57%** — the strongest quarter because Jan–Mar is the mining industry's peak season (monsoon over).
- **But the boom is price-led, not volume-led.** Ore output rose only ~6–9%; the profit surge came mostly from high global copper prices flowing straight to the bottom line. That is a cyclical tailwind, not a permanent gain.
- **The big plan is now official.** Board cleared "**Vision 2030**": spend ~₹7,189 cr to **triple ore capacity** from 4.2 to 12.2 million tonnes a year by FY30, lifting projected profit from ~₹589 cr (FY26 base) to ~₹1,568 cr (FY30).
- **Market reaction was cool.** Despite the record results, the share fell when Vision 2030 was announced — investors saw the targets as long-dated and the stock as already expensive. Dividend: ₹1 interim + ₹1.86 final for FY26.

Business mix & capacity (quick facts)

- **Domestic vs export:** Effectively **~100% domestic now**. Management said India is short of copper concentrate, so all output is sold at home; earlier exports were a "compulsion" they have stopped. (Roughly all sales stay within India.)
- **Capacity use / expansion:** Currently mining **~4.2 million tonnes of ore a year**, targeting **12.2 million tonnes by FY30-31** — i.e. output must roughly triple. (Lots of headroom promised, but it needs new shafts, imported equipment and reopened mines to get there.)

3. Earning-trigger thesis HEADLINE

The one thing management keeps pointing to: tripling how much copper ore it can dig — from ~4.2 to **12.2 million tonnes a year by 2030-31** — by reopening long-closed mines in Jharkhand (Rakha, shut since 2001; Kendadih; Surda), equipping two finished shafts at the big Malanjkhand mine in Madhya Pradesh, and using outside "mine developer-operators" (a JSW group company will invest ~₹2,600 cr to run Rakha). More ore, sold at high copper prices, is meant to roughly triple profit over five years. A technical tie-up with Chile's Codelco (the world's biggest copper miner) is meant to bring in know-how.

Trigger	What management said	Evidence so far	Time horizon	Strength
Triple ore output to 12.2 MT/yr	₹7,189 cr spend; profit ₹589 cr → ₹1,568 cr by FY30	Clearances finally in hand; MDO appointed (Jan 2026); Surda restarted; FY26 output a 7-year high	FY27–FY31 (back-ended)	Moderate — concrete and finally unblocked, but the big volumes are years out
Reopen Jharkhand mines (Rakha/Kendadih)	Leases signed; Rakha output "within 16–18 months"	Forest & environment clearances received 2025; MDO signed	Rakha not before Q4 FY27	Unproven — real progress, but zero tonnes yet after a 20-year wait
				Weak/near-term — hinges on an imported-

Malanjkhand 5 MT ramp (shaft equipping)	Two shafts sunk; only winders/ equipping left	Winders must be imported (Europe); an earlier tender failed once	~30–32 months after order	equipment tender that has slipped before
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Honest note: today's record earnings are driven mostly by **high copper prices**, not by this expansion. The expansion is the future story; the present profit is a commodity-price tailwind.

4. Management-consistency scorecard

Have they done what they said? A mixed but improving picture — strong on near-term delivery, patchy on the long-promised expansion.

Period	What was promised	What actually happened	Verdict
Long-running (many years)	Reopen Jharkhand mines; reach 12 MT ore capacity	Stuck for 20+ years on forest/environment clearances split between state & centre; targets repeatedly pushed out	Missed / slipped (historically)
FY25–FY26	Secure clearances, sign leases, appoint mine operator	Clearances received 2025; leases signed; JSW-group MDO appointed Jan 2026 — genuinely delivered	Delivered
FY26 guidance	~20% volume growth; margins above 40%	Output at 7-year high; margins 48% full-year, ~57% in Q4 — met/beat	Delivered
Vision 2030 (FY26 onward)	Triple capacity to 12.2 MT by FY30; profit to ₹1,568 cr	Just announced; real spending and ramp lie ahead	Too early

Narrative drift: The *headline number* ("12 million tonnes") has been repeated for years and has a clear **history of slipping** — Rakha alone stayed shut from 2001 to 2025. What is new and encouraging is that in the last 12–18 months the paperwork logjam finally broke: clearances came, leases were signed, and an operator was appointed. Management (led by the CMD, a career mining engineer) is unusually **candid** on the calls — openly flagging monsoon production losses, difficult geology, past failures and equipment-import risk, and giving specific numbers rather than spin. So the story is steady in direction and honestly told, but the flagship target keeps moving to the right.

5. Bottom line — two verdicts

Durable earning trigger? → MAYBE

There *is* a real, concrete trigger — the capacity-tripling plan — and after a two-decade wait it is finally unblocked (clearances secured, operator appointed, one mine restarted). That is more than a wish. But it is **unproven at scale**: the big volume gains are 2–5 years out, hinge on imported shaft equipment that has slipped before, and today's record profit is riding **high copper prices**, not yet new tonnes. Genuine driver, not yet delivered — so MAYBE, not a clean YES.

Management consistent? → MAYBE

Two sides. On the **plus**: near-term guidance was met or beaten (record output and margins), the long-stuck clearances finally came through, and management is refreshingly honest on calls. On the **minus**: the flagship "12 million tonnes" target has a long history of being promised and delayed, so the multi-year timeline deserves a pinch of salt. Steady direction and good recent delivery, but a slippage-prone big goal — MAYBE.

Sources: Screener.in transcript (investor meet 18 Sep 2025) and financial snapshot; company FY26/Q4 results and Vision-2030 filings (15 May 2026); BSE/company IR and business press (Business Standard, Whalesbook, PSU Connect, Business Today, Metalnomist). This is not investment advice.